

graphics with very few frame skips. However, move on to High Graphics or more heavy-duty games such as Gen-shin Impact, and you will see this phone falter compared to the likes of the POCO X6 Pro. Additionally, the phone also doesn't throttle too much as indicated by the CPU Throttling Test.

Real-world experience aside, I ran multiple benchmarks to objectively assert the performance of the Galaxy A35. The results, while not terrible, weren't up to the standards of competitors. For example, the Galaxy A35 scored 6,09,463 points in AnTuTu v10 which was significantly lower than the POCO X6 Pro, Redmi Note 13 Pro+, and OnePlus Nord CE4's scores. These competing phones also beat the Galaxy A35's GeekBench Single Core and Multi-Core score, with the exception of the Redmi Note 13 Pro+'s Multi-Core score. However, the A35 bagged an impressive score of 13,207 in PCMark Work.

In gaming benchmarks, the Samsung Galaxy A35's scores were destroyed by that of the OnePlus Nord CE4, indicating that gaming enthusiasts must look in the other direction. The phone scored only 812 points in 3D Mark Wild Life Extreme which is one of the lowest scores amongst phones above ₹25K in 2024.

The UI experience makes up for it though. OneUI has some bloatware, but the smoothness is almost unparalleled in the mid-range segment (save for NothingOS). You also get excellent update support – four years of OS updates and five years of security updates. This far exceeds others that provide merely two or three years at this price.

CAMERA

While the secondary 8 MP ultrawide camera and tertiary 5 MP macro camera have been ported over from the Samsung Galaxy A35's predecessor, the company has upgraded the primary shooter. You get a 50 MP primary camera with f/1.8 aperture and OIS support. Samsung has also promised improved imagery

with the chipset's upgraded NPU and ISP. For selfies, you get a modest 13 MP shooter. Both the rear and front cameras can shoot 4K videos at 30 fps. In contrast, its competitors such as the Redmi Note 13 Pro+ and OnePlus Nord CE4 can only shoot 1080p video from their respective selfie cameras.

Photos shot from the primary camera in daylight have good detail and colour reproduction. The photos have a slightly warm hue, which looks pretty decent. The dynamic range is solid; there's plenty of information in the shadow areas while the highlights are also kept in check. The 8 MP ultrawide camera has similar colour science with good levels of detail. There is some distortion towards the edges though. Daylight videos in 4K are also very impressive for a phone costing ₹30,999.

Close-up photos look great as well. The details are well-preserved and the colours look excellent. The natural depth of field looks natural too.

Portrait photos are excellent on the Samsung Galaxy A35. The edge detection, while not perfect, is one of the best at this price point. Additionally, skin tones look very natural; close to mimicking what we see in real life, which I really appreciate. The texture of the skin is also preserved; there's no odd smoothening going on here. Selfies also look brilliant, with natural skin tone reproduction.

As for low-light photography, the performance is pretty decent. There is some noise in these pictures, but the colours look natural. Night Mode enhances the detail levels in the pictures. Overall, a solid showing for a phone around the ₹30K price point but the noise levels should be fixed via an OTA update.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery life on the Samsung Galaxy A35 is nothing to write home about, but it's not horrendous either. Competitors such as the OnePlus Nord CE4 and the iQOO Neo 9 Pro have showcased superior endurance. However, for most casual users, you will get a day's worth of juice with relative ease.

The phone houses a 5,000 mAh cell with support for 25 W wired charging. There's no charger in the box, which is disappointing as most users may not have a 25 W charger on hand and would have to buy one separately.

The Samsung Galaxy A35 lasted over 14 hours in our 4K video loop test on VLC, which is a decent score but not the best in the mid-range category. An hour's worth of GPS navigation drained the battery by about 8 per cent. The charging speeds are on the slower side with the phone taking a good 94 minutes to charge from empty to full.

VERDICT

The Samsung Galaxy A35 is a reliable choice at ₹30,999. The phone impressed me with its stellar camera performance, smooth UI, and immersive display. There are a lot of niceties on offer as well such as Gorilla Glass Victus+ display protection, 4 years of OS updates, 4K video recording on the rear and selfie cameras, and a solid build. For those who don't covet performance over everything else, the Galaxy A35 is one of the best all-rounders you can get your hands on at a relatively pocket-friendly price. However, the lack of HDR support for the display and the absence of a charging brick in the box dock away some of its points. Additionally, the Samsung Galaxy A35 is not suitable for gamers as the chipset doesn't handle High Graphics gaming too well. As a package though, the Samsung Galaxy A35 is more polished than competitors priced similarly.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Exynos 1380 | Manufacturing process: 5 nm | GPU: Mali-G68 MP5 | OS: Android 14, One UI 6.1 | Display: 6.6" Super AMOLED, 1080 x 2340 pixels, 120 Hz | Display protection: Corning Gorilla Glass Victus+ | Cameras: 50 MP + 8 MP + 5 MP | Front camera: 13 MP | Stereo speakers: Yes | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 25 W | IP rating: IP67 | Colours: Iceblue, Lilac, Navy

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